

Python

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1 Standard Library

Core Concept 1.1: Libraries

A **library** is a broadly distributed, reusable collection of packages and modules that provides generalised functionality intended to be shared across many independent projects. Unlike a module or package, a library is not a formally defined construct within the Python; rather, it is an organisational and distributional concept. The distinction between a package and a library is primarily one of scale and intent: a package is a unit of code organisation within a project, whereas a library is a distribution of functionality designed for broad external consumption.

Core Concept 1.2: Standard Library

The **Python Standard Library** is a comprehensive collection of modules that comes with the Python interpreter upon installation, requiring no external package manager or configuration to access. Each module within the standard library addresses a distinct domain of common programming tasks, spanning areas such as file I/O, networking, data serialisation, concurrency, mathematics, and string manipulation, among others.

The modules and packages introduced in the following section will recur throughout the subsequent material, appearing either as the primary subject of discussion or as supplementary tooling within broader coding demonstrations.

1.1 Core Modules & Packages

1.1.1 Data Serialization & Storage

Core Concept 1.3: json

The `json` module provides a standardised interface for serialising Python objects into JSON (JavaScript Object Notation) format and deserialising JSON-formatted strings back into native Python objects. It is most commonly used when exchanging data with web APIs or writing structured data to a file.

- (a) `json.dumps(obj)` serializes a Python object into a JSON-formatted string. You can also serialize a Python object and write the result directly to a file object `fp` through `json.dump(obj, fp)`.

```
1 >>> import json
2
3 >>> data = {'name': 'Alice', 'age': 30}
4
5 >>> json_string = json.dumps(data) # Python object -> json string
6 >>> print(json_string)
7 {"name": "Alice", "age": 30}
8
9 >>> with open('data.json', 'w') as fp: # Python object -> json file
10 ...     json.dump(data, fp)
11 ...
```

Code 1: Serializing a Python object to JSON using `json.dumps()` and `json.dump()`

- (b) `json.loads(obj)`, on the other hand, deserializes a JSON-formatted string back into a native Python object. Likewise, you can write the result directly to a file object `fp` through `json.load(fp)`.

```
1 >>> import json
2
```

```

3 >>> json_string = '{"name": "Alice", "age": 30}'
4
5 >>> data_from_string = json.loads(json_string) # json string -> Python object
6 >>> print(data_from_string)
7 {'name': 'Alice', 'age': 30}
8
9 >>> with open('data.json', 'r') as fp: # json file -> Python object
10 ...     data_from_file = json.load(fp)
11 ...
12 >>> print(data_from_file)
13 {'name': 'Alice', 'age': 30}

```

Code 2: Deserializing a JSON-formatted string to a Python object using `json.loads()` and `json.load()`

Core Concept 1.4: pickle

The `pickle` module implements a Python-specific binary serialisation protocol, enabling arbitrary Python objects—including custom class instances, functions, and data structures not supported by JSON—to be converted into a machine code and subsequently reconstructed. This process is referred to as **pickling** (*serialisation*) and **unpickling** (*deserialisation*) respectively.

A more detailed treatment of the pickling protocol is provided in Core Concept 4.3.

Core Concept 1.5: xml

The `xml` module provides tooling for parsing, traversing, and constructing XML (eXtensible Markup Language) documents. The most practical sub-module for general use is `xml.etree.ElementTree`—often imported under the alias `ET` for brevity—which represents an XML document as a navigable tree of `Element` objects and is the idiomatic interface for XML processing within the standard library.

(a) `ET.parse(file)` parses an XML file and returns an `ElementTree` object representing the full document.

```

1 >>> import xml.etree.ElementTree as ET
2
3 >>> tree = ET.parse('inventory.xml')
4 >>> print(type(tree))
5 <class 'xml.etree.ElementTree.ElementTree'>

```

Code 3: Parsing an XML file through `ET.parse()`

- `tree.getroot()` returns the root `Element` of a parsed `ElementTree` object.

```

1 >>> import xml.etree.ElementTree as ET
2 >>> tree = ET.parse('inventory.xml')
3
4 >>> root = tree.getroot()
5 >>> print(root.tag)
6 store

```

Code 4: Retrieving the root `Element` of an `ElementTree` object using `.getroot()`

(b) `ET.fromstring(s)` parses an XML string and returns the root `Element` object.

```

1 >>> import xml.etree.ElementTree as ET

```

```

2
3 >>> xml_data = '<store name="TechHub"><item>Laptop</item></store>'
4
5 >>> root = ET.fromstring(xml_data)
6 >>> print(type(root))
7 <class 'xml.etree.ElementTree.Element'>
8 >>> print(root.tag)
9 store

```

Code 5: Parsing an XML string through `ET.fromstring()`

- `element.find(tag)` returns the first child `Element` matching the specified tag, or `None` if not found.
- `element.findall(tag)` returns a list of all child `Element`s matching the specified tag.
- `element.get(attr)` retrieves the value of a specified attribute from an `Element`.

```

1 >>> import xml.etree.ElementTree as ET
2
3 >>> xml_data = '''
4 ... <store name="TechHub">
5 ...     <item id="1">Laptop</item>
6 ...     <item id="2">Mouse</item>
7 ... </store>
8 ... '''
9 >>> root = ET.fromstring(xml_data)
10
11 >>> print(root.get('name')) # fetching an attribute value
12 TechHub
13
14 >>> first_item = root.find('item') # getting ONLY the first matching child element
15 >>> print(first_item.text)
16 Laptop
17
18 >>> all_items = root.findall('item') # retrieving a list of ALL matching child
19     elements
20 >>> print([item.text for item in all_items])
21 ['Laptop', 'Mouse']

```

Code 6: Retrieving attributes and child `Element`s from a given parent `Element` object using `.find()`, `.findall()`, and `.get()`

1.1.2 File System & OS Interface

Core Concept 1.6: os

The `os` module provides portable tooling for interacting with the underlying operating system. It serves as the standard library's primary interface for file system navigation, directory and file manipulation, and environment configuration management.

(a) Navigating and Querying the File System

- `os.getcwd()` returns the absolute path string of the current working directory.

```

1 >>> import os
2
3 >>> current_dir = os.getcwd()
4 >>> print(current_dir)

```

```
5 /Users/ingyubahng/ibahng-com/computer_science/python
```

Code 7: Querying the active system directory using `os.getcwd()`

- `os.chdir(path)` changes the current working directory to the specified path target.
- `os.listdir(path='.')` returns a list containing the names of the entries within the given directory.

```
1 >>> import os
2
3 >>> entries = os.listdir('.')
4 >>> print(entries)
5 ['python.synctex.gz', 'math_utils.py', 'python.pdf', 'inventory.xml',
  ↪ 'pythontex-files-python', 'python.tex', 'python.fdb_latexmk', 'python.toc',
  ↪ 'session.pkl', 'python.out', '__pycache__', 'data.json', 'sandbox',
  ↪ 'python.pytxcode', 'sensor_data.txt', 'python.fls', 'python.log', 'python.aux']
```

Code 8: Listing directory contents through `os.listdir()`

(b) Managing Files and Directories

- `os.mkdir(path)` creates a single directory at the specified path.
- `os.makedirs(path)` recursively creates a target directory along with any missing intermediate directories.
- `os.remove(path)` removes a file path target.
- `os.rmdir(path)` removes an empty directory path target.
- `os.rename(src, dst)` renames a file or directory from the source path to the destination path.

```
1 >>> import os
2 >>> import shutil
3
4 >>> shutil.rmtree('./sandbox', ignore_errors=True) # recursively deletes the entire
  ↪ sandbox directory tree if it exists; this is in order to start with a clean
  ↪ slate
5
6 >>> os.makedirs('./sandbox', exist_ok=True)
7 >>> os.chdir('./sandbox')
8 >>> print(os.listdir('.'))
9 []
10
11 >>> os.mkdir('test_dir')
12 >>> print(os.listdir('.'))
13 ['test_dir']
14
15 >>> os.rename('test_dir', 'renamed_dir')
16 >>> print(os.listdir('.'))
17 ['renamed_dir']
18
19 >>> os.makedirs('renamed_dir/sub_parent/child', exist_ok=True)
20 >>> print(os.listdir('renamed_dir'))
21 ['sub_parent']
22
23 >>> with open('renamed_dir/sub_parent/child/temp.txt', 'w') as f:
24 ...     f.write('Clean up test')
25 ...
26 13
27 >>> print(os.listdir('renamed_dir/sub_parent/child'))
```

```
28 ['temp.txt']
29
30 >>> os.remove('renamed_dir/sub_parent/child/temp.txt')
31 >>> print(os.listdir('renamed_dir/sub_parent/child'))
32 []
33
34 >>> os.rmdir('renamed_dir/sub_parent/child')
35 >>> print(os.listdir('renamed_dir/sub_parent'))
36 []
37
38 >>> os.chdir('..')
```

Code 9: Demonstrating directory creation, file system manipulation, and selective deletion within a sandboxed environment

(c) Retrieving Environment Variables

- `os.environ` maps the current environment keys and values to a dictionary-like object interface.
- `os.getenv(key, default=None)` safe-extracts the configuration value matching a given key without throwing an exception.

```
1 >>> import os
2
3 >>> user_profile = os.getenv('USER', 'default_user')
4 >>> print(user_profile)
5 ingyubahng
```

Code 10: Extracting host configuration properties using `os.getenv()`

Core Concept 1.7: subprocess

The `subprocess` module provides the standard interface for manipulating processes. In layman's terms, `subprocess` is the module that allows a developer to run terminal commands via Python scripts and subsequently read the results.

(a) Executing System Commands

- `subprocess.run(args)` is the primary workhorse function that executes the command described by `args`, waits for command completion, and returns a `CompletedProcess` instance. Security best practices dictate passing commands as a list of strings rather than a single string.

```
1 >>> import subprocess
2
3 >>> result = subprocess.run(['echo', 'Hello from the subshell!'])
4 >>> print(result) # returncode of 0 means success
5 CompletedProcess(args=['echo', 'Hello from the subshell!'], returncode=0)
```

Code 11: Executing a basic shell command using `subprocess.run()`

(b) Capturing Command Output

- Passing `capture_output=True` alongside `text=True` routes the standard output and standard error streams directly into the returned `CompletedProcess` object as readable string attributes. The absence of `text=True` return byte objects.

```

1 >>> import subprocess
2
3 >>> result = subprocess.run(['echo', 'Captured output data'], capture_output=True,
  ↳ text=True)
4
5 >>> print(result)
6 CompletedProcess(args=['echo', 'Captured output data'], returncode=0,
  ↳ stdout='Captured output data\n', stderr='')

```

Code 12: Capturing standard output from an external process

(c) Enforcing Safe Execution Status

- Passing `check=True` instructs the function to raise a `subprocess.CalledProcessError` exception if the underlying process exits with a non-zero status code, enforcing strict error boundaries.

```

1 >>> import subprocess
2
3 >>> subprocess.run(['python', '-c', 'import sys; sys.exit(1)'], capture_output=True,
  ↳ text=True) # intentionally exits with an error, no CalledProcessError
4 CompletedProcess(args=['python', '-c', 'import sys; sys.exit(1)'], returncode=1,
  ↳ stdout='', stderr='')
5
6 >>> subprocess.run(['python', '-c', 'import sys; sys.exit(1)'], check=True,
  ↳ capture_output=True, text=True) # intentionally exits with an error status (1)
7 Traceback (most recent call last):
8   File "<stdin>", line 1, in <module>
9   File "/opt/anaconda3/lib/python3.11/subprocess.py", line 571, in run
10     raise CalledProcessError(retcode, process.args,
11 subprocess.CalledProcessError: Command '['python', '-c', 'import sys; sys.exit(1)']'
  ↳ returned non-zero exit status 1.

```

Code 13: Handling execution failures using `check=True`**Core Concept 1.8: sys**

The `sys` module provides access to variables and functions that interact directly with the Python runtime environment. It is the primary tool for querying interpreter details, handling standard input/output streams, processing command-line arguments, and controlling script termination.

(a) Interpreter and Runtime Information

- `sys.version` returns a string containing the Python version number alongside additional build information and compiler details.
- `sys.version_info` returns a named tuple detailing the five components of the version number (major, minor, micro, releaselevel, and serial), which is highly useful for programmatic version checking.
- `sys.platform` returns a string identifying the underlying operating system platform—e.g., `'linux'`, `'darwin'`, `'win32'`—on which Python is executing.
- `sys.executable` returns a string providing the absolute path to the executable binary of the Python interpreter currently running the script.

```

1 >>> import sys
2
3 >>> print(sys.version)
4 3.11.11 (main, Dec 11 2024, 10:25:04) [Clang 14.0.6 ]

```

```

5 >>> print(sys.version_info)
6 sys.version_info(major=3, minor=11, micro=11, releaselevel='final', serial=0)
7 >>> print(sys.platform)
8 darwin
9 >>> print(sys.executable)
10 /opt/anaconda3/bin/python

```

Code 14: Querying host platform and interpreter properties

(b) Command-Line Arguments

- `sys.argv` is a list containing the command-line arguments passed to a Python script in the terminal.

```
python sys_arg0 sys_arg1 sys_arg2 ...
```

By convention, `sys.argv[0]` always holds the name of the script itself, while the sliced list `sys.argv[1:]` isolates the actual arguments provided by the user in the terminal.

(c) Standard I/O Streams

- `sys.stdin`, `sys.stdout`, and `sys.stderr` are file objects used by the interpreter for standard input, standard output, and standard errors, respectively. For instance, the built-in `print()` function acts as a convenient wrapper around `sys.stdout.write()`.

```

1 >>> import sys
2
3 >>> # functionally equivalent to print("Standard output message")
4 >>> sys.stdout.write("Standard output message\n")
5 Standard output message
6 24
7
8 >>> # emitting an error message that bypasses standard output redirection
9 >>> sys.stderr.write("Warning: Configuration file missing.\n")
10 37

```

Code 15: Writing directly to system output and error streams

- Writing directly to `sys.stderr` allows developers to separate error diagnostics and warning messages from the primary program output stream. For instance, the following terminal Python execution script allows errors/warnings and outputs to be outputted into two different files `err.txt` and `out.txt`, respectively.

```
python script.py > out.txt 2> err.txt
```

(d) Script Termination

- `sys.exit([arg])` forces the Python interpreter to safely terminate the running script. Passing an integer of `0` implies a successful, expected completion, whereas passing any non-zero integer—commonly `1`—signals an error or abnormal exit condition to the host operating system.

Core Concept 1.9: glob

The `glob` module provides a mechanism for identifying file paths that match a specified pattern according to the rules utilized by the Unix shell. It is the idiomatic standard library tool for pattern-based directory traversal, bulk file identification, and wildcard filtering.

(a) Pattern Matching and File Retrieval

- `glob.glob(pathname, *, recursive=False)` returns a populated list of path strings that match the specified `pathname`. The string can contain shell-style wildcards such as `*` (matches any sequence of characters), `?` (matches any single character), and `[seq]` (matches any character in `seq`). When `recursive=True` is passed, the `**` pattern matches zero or more directories and subdirectories recursively.

```
1 >>> import glob
2 >>> import os
3
4 >>> print(os.getcwd())
5 /Users/ingyubahng/ibahng-com/computer_science/python
6
7 >>> py_files = glob.glob('*.py') # retrieve all Python source files in the active
  ↳ directory
8 >>> print(py_files)
9 ['math_utils.py']
10
11 >>> txt_files = glob.glob('**/*.pkl', recursive=True) # retrieve all text files
  ↳ spanning a nested directory structure
12 >>> print(txt_files)
13 ['session.pkl', 'pythontex-files-python/pythontex_data.pkl']
```

Code 16: Extracting file paths using shell-style wildcard patterns via `glob.glob()`

(b) Memory-Efficient Iteration

- `glob.iglob(pathname, *, recursive=False)` provides the exact same pattern-matching semantics as `glob.glob()`, but returns an iterator instead of a fully realized list. This deferred execution model is highly optimal for systems programming, as it prevents memory exhaustion when traversing directories that contain thousands of files.

```
1 >>> import glob
2
3 >>> # Initialize an iterator for CSV files
4 >>> csv_iterator = glob.iglob('data/*.csv')
5 >>> print(type(csv_iterator))
6 <class 'generator'>
7
8 >>> # Consume the iterator sequentially without bulk memory allocation
9 >>> for filepath in csv_iterator:
10 ...     print(f"Processing: {filepath}")
11 ...
```

Code 17: Generating an iterator for memory-efficient path traversal using `glob.iglob()`

(c) Pattern Escaping

- `glob.escape(pathname)` neutralizes special wildcard characters (`*`, `?`, and `[`) by explicitly escaping them. This is functionally necessary when searching within directories whose literal names inadvertently contain shell-reserved characters, ensuring the interpreter does not evaluate them as pattern syntax.

```
1 >>> import glob
2
3 >>> # A literal directory name containing shell-reserved characters
4 >>> tricky_dir = "results_[final]*"
5
```

```

6 >>> safe_pattern = glob.escape(tricky_dir)
7 >>> print(safe_pattern)
8 results_ [[]final] [*]
9
10 >>> # Safely executing a search inside the explicitly escaped directory
11 >>> files = glob.glob(f"{safe_pattern}/*.json")

```

Code 18: Sanitizing arbitrary strings for literal path matching using `glob.escape()`

1.1.3 Mathematics & Randomness

Core Concept 1.10: random

Core Concept 1.11: math

1.1.4 Time & Scheduling

1.1.5 Concurrency & Data Structures

1.1.6 Regular Expressions

1.1.7 SWE Utilities

Core Concept 1.12: datetime

datetime <https://docs.python.org/3/library/datetime.html>

datetime module methods `datetime.today()` → time in GMT `datetime.now()` → time in LOCAL `date()` `time()` `combine()`

You can check for expiration date like this

```

1 >>> from datetime import *
2
3 >>> def validateCard(expDate):
4 ...     if expDate>datetime.now().date(): #now() returns the date and time; date()
5 ...         print("Valid")
6 ...     else:
7 ...         print("Expired")
8 ...
9 >>> validateCard(date(2020,2,2))
10 Expired

```

Code 19

Core Concept 1.13: time

time <https://docs.python.org/3/library/time.html>

Epoch is the start of time on machines: January 1st 1970

time module methods time() ctime() perf_counter() sleep()

Core Concept 1.14: abc

abc <https://docs.python.org/3/library/abc.html>

Core Concept 1.15: re

re <https://docs.python.org/3/library/re.html>

From this point on, many coding demonstrations will include the use of certain modules and packages

2 Object Oriented Programming

2.1 Classes

Core Concept 2.1: Classes, Attributes, and Methods

A `class` is a blueprint for creating objects that encapsulates data and behavior into a cohesive construct, enabling modular code organization and reusability.

```
1 >>> class BankAccount:
2 ...     bank = "Chase" # class attribute
3 ...     def __init__(self, owner, balance=0):
4 ...         self.owner = owner # instance attribute
5 ...         self.balance = balance # instance attribute
6 ...     def deposit(self, amount): #method
7 ...         self.balance += amount
8 ...         return self.balance
9 ...     def withdraw(self, amount):
10 ...         if amount <= self.balance:
11 ...             self.balance -= amount
12 ...             return self.balance
13 ...         return "Insufficient funds"
14 ...
15 >>> account = BankAccount("Alice", 100)
16 >>> print(account.deposit(50))
17 150
18 >>> print(account.withdraw(30))
19 120
20 >>> print(account.balance)
21 120
```

Code 20: `class` instantiation, attributes, and methods

The `__init__()` method serves as a special constructor that initializes new class instances, executing automatically upon object instantiation. The `self` parameter references the specific instance being created or manipulated, providing access to that instance's attributes and methods.

Attributes represent the data stored within a class and are categorized into two distinct types.

- **Class attributes** are shared uniformly across all instances of a class. In the `BankAccount` example, `bank = "Chase"` constitutes a class attribute accessible to all `BankAccount` objects.

- **Instance attributes** are unique to each individual object. Attributes such as `self.owner` and `self.balance` must be explicitly provided during instantiation, as demonstrated by `account = BankAccount("Alice", 100)`.

Methods are functions defined within a class namespace that operate on instance data. These functions are bound to the class and accessible only through class instances. In the example above, `deposit()` and `withdraw()` exemplify methods that represent the behavioral logic of the `BankAccount` class, specifically the `self.balance` attribute.

Core Concept 2.2: Setters & Getters

Setters and **getters** are methods that control access to an object's attributes outside of the initialization of the class. These methods of control can be written in one of two ways.

- (a) **Explicit Method:** The setter and getter are just written as plain functions.

```

1 >>> class Example:
2 ...     def setName(self, n): # setter
3 ...         self.name = n
4 ...     def getName(self): # getter
5 ...         return self.name
6 ...
7 >>> p1 = Example()
8 >>> p1.setName("John")
9 >>> print(p1.getName())
10 John

```

Code 21: Explicit setter and getter method

- (b) **Decorator Method:** The setter and getter methods are decorated with the `@property` and `@<attribute>.setter` annotations.

By convention, attributes prefixed with a single underscore in the format of `_attribute` indicate internal implementation details that should not be accessed directly, though Python does not enforce true privacy.

```

1 >>> class PythonicExample:
2 ...     def __init__(self, name):
3 ...         self._name = name # Protected backing attribute
4 ...     @property
5 ...     def name(self): # Getter decorator
6 ...         return self._name
7 ...     @name.setter
8 ...     def name(self, n): # Setter decorator
9 ...         if not n:
10 ...             raise ValueError("Name cannot be empty")
11 ...         self._name = n
12 ...
13 >>> p2 = PythonicExample("John")
14 >>> p2.name = "Sally" # Intercepted by the setter seamlessly
15 >>> print(p2.name)   # Intercepted by the getter seamlessly
16 Sally

```

Code 22: Decorator setter and getter method

The difference is how Python handles attribute access under the hood. The explicit method relies on traditional function calls like `p1.setName()`, which creates a nightmare when trying to convert all `p1.name = <name>`

lines for all class instances to the `p1.setName()` method, resulting in every file interacting with that variable having to be refactored.

Conversely, the decorator method hooks directly into Python's descriptor protocol such as `p2.name = "Sally"` (setter) and `p2.name` (getter) in the above example. This wraps the underlying functions into a property descriptor object, allowing outside code to maintain the clean, direct assignment syntax of `p2.name = "Sally"`.

The decorator method is simply the undisputed industry standard way to handle setters and getters because it gives the developer the power to add data validation, transformation, or read-only access control in the background with ease. For instance, omitting the matching setter to a property getter creates a strict read-only functionality for an attribute.

```

1 >>> class ReadOnlyExample:
2 ...     def __init__(self, name):
3 ...         self._name = name # Protected backing attribute
4 ...     @property
5 ...     def name(self): # Getter decorator
6 ...         return self._name
7 ...     # Note: The .setter decorator is intentionally omitted to make it read-only
8 ...
9 >>> p3 = ReadOnlyExample("John")
10 >>> print(p3.name) # Read access works perfectly via the getter
11 John
12
13 >>> # Attempting to modify the attribute will now throw an AttributeError
14 >>> p3.name = "Sally"
15 Traceback (most recent call last):
16   File "<stdin>", line 1, in <module>
17 AttributeError: property 'name' of 'ReadOnlyExample' object has no setter

```

Code 23: Setter omission creating a read-only functionality for an attribute

2.2 The Four Pillars of Object Oriented Programming

Core Concept 2.3: Encapsulation

Encapsulation is the practice of bundling data attributes and their associated methods into a cohesive class unit while restricting direct external access through access control mechanisms. This design principle protects internal state integrity by exposing controlled interfaces rather than allowing direct manipulation of object internals.

```

1 >>> class BankAccount:
2 ...     def __init__(self, owner, initial_deposit):
3 ...         self.owner = owner
4 ...         self._balance = initial_deposit
5 ...     @property
6 ...     def balance(self):
7 ...         return f"{self._balance:,.2f}"
8 ...     def display_balance(self):
9 ...         return f"{self._balance:,.2f}"
10 ...
11 >>> account = BankAccount("Ingyu", 1000)
12 >>> print(account.balance) # getter method
13 1,000.00
14 >>> print(account.display_balance()) # explicit function
15 1,000.00
16 >>> print(account._BankAccount__balance) # name mangling
17 1000

```

```

18
19 >>> print(account.__balance) # private attributes cannot be directly accessed
20 Traceback (most recent call last):
21   File "<stdin>", line 1, in <module>
22 AttributeError: 'BankAccount' object has no attribute '__balance'

```

Code 24: Encapsulation and `class` private attributes using `__attribute` syntax

The double underscore prefix (`__attribute`) designates an attribute as private, triggering Python's name mangling mechanism that converts the attribute name to `_ClassName__attribute`. While this prevents direct external access via the original attribute name, the value remains retrievable through properly designed accessor methods (*getters*), explicit retrieval functions, or by explicitly invoking the mangled name syntax—though the latter circumvents the intended encapsulation and is considered poor practice.

Core Concept 2.4: Inheritance

Inheritance is a fundamental object-oriented mechanism whereby a child class (*subclass*) acquires the attributes and methods of a parent class (*superclass*), facilitating code reuse and enabling the hierarchical extension of functionality without redundancy.

```

1 >>> class Animal:
2 ...     def __init__(self, name):
3 ...         self.name = name
4 ...     def eat(self):
5 ...         return f"{self.name} is eating."
6 ...     def speak(self):
7 ...         return f"{self.name} makes a generic sound."
8 ...
9 >>> class Dog(Animal):
10 ...     def speak(self):
11 ...         return f"{self.name} barks: Woof!"
12 ...
13 >>> my_dog = Dog("Buddy")
14 >>> print(my_dog.eat())
15 Buddy is eating.
16 >>> print(my_dog.speak())
17 Buddy barks: Woof!

```

Code 25: Inheritance of parent `Animal` by child `Dog`

In the above code block, the `Dog` class inherits all attributes and methods from the `Animal` parent class. When a child class defines a method with an identical name to a parent class method—such as `speak()` in this example—the child implementation completely overrides the parent version, a behavior known as **method overriding**.

In addition to the simple inheritance shown above, the `super()` function allows the user to return a proxy object that delegates method calls to the parent class, enabling controlled inheritance and method extension. This mechanism serves two primary purposes.

- **Constructor Extension:** Child class constructors frequently require both parent initialization logic and child-specific setup. The expression `super().__init__()` delegates baseline initialization to the parent constructor, ensuring proper attribute inheritance while permitting the addition of child-specific attributes.
- **Method Extension:** While method overriding replaces parent functionality entirely,

`super().method_name()` allows child classes to invoke parent method logic before or after executing child-specific operations, thereby extending rather than replacing inherited behavior.

```
1 >>> class Vehicle:
2 ...     def __init__(self, brand, model):
3 ...         self.brand = brand
4 ...         self.model = model
5 ...     def description(self):
6 ...         return f"{self.brand} {self.model}"
7 ...
8 >>> class Car(Vehicle):
9 ...     def __init__(self, brand, model, doors):
10 ...         super().__init__(brand, model)
11 ...         self.doors = doors
12 ...     def description(self):
13 ...         base_info = super().description()
14 ...         return f"{base_info} with {self.doors} doors"
15 ...
16 >>> car = Car("Toyota", "Camry", 4)
17 >>> print(car.description())
18 Toyota Camry with 4 doors
```

Code 26: Method extension using `super()`

Core Concept 2.5: Polymorphism

Polymorphism is the capacity of different classes to implement identically named methods, enabling a single unified interface to operate on diverse object types while invoking class-specific behavior. This principle allows functions to process heterogeneous objects uniformly, with runtime behavior determined by each object's concrete class implementation.

```
1 >>> class MasterCard:
2 ...     def process_payment(self, amount):
3 ...         return f"Processing ${amount:.2f} via MasterCard networks."
4 ...
5 >>> class PayPal:
6 ...     def process_payment(self, amount):
7 ...         return f"Routing ${amount:.2f} through PayPal wallets."
8 ...
9 >>> class Bitcoin:
10 ...     def process_payment(self, amount):
11 ...         return f"Broadcasting ${amount:.2f} to blockchain."
12 ...
13 >>> class ApplePay:
14 ...     def process_payment(self, amount):
15 ...         return f"Authenticating ${amount:.2f} via Apple."
16 ...
17 >>> def checkout_gate(payment_processor, total):
18 ...     print(payment_processor.process_payment(total))
19 ...
20 >>> visa, wallet, crypto, mobile = MasterCard(), PayPal(), Bitcoin(), ApplePay()
21
22 >>> checkout_gate(visa, 150.00)
23 Processing $150.00 via MasterCard networks.
24 >>> checkout_gate(wallet, 150.00)
25 Routing $150.00 through PayPal wallets.
26 >>> checkout_gate(crypto, 150.00)
27 Broadcasting $150.00 to blockchain.
28 >>> checkout_gate(mobile, 150.00)
```

29 Authenticating \$150.00 via Apple.

Code 27: Polymorphism and identically named method `process_payment` executing different actions based on paired `class`

Each payment processor class implements an identically named `process_payment()` method with class-specific logic. The `checkout_gate()` function accepts any payment processor object and invokes its `process_payment()` method, demonstrating polymorphic behavior: the same function call produces different outputs depending on the runtime type of the object passed as an argument. This design enables extensibility—new payment processor classes can be added without modifying the `checkout_gate()` function, provided they implement the `process_payment()` interface.

Core Concept 2.6: Abstraction

Abstraction is a fundamental architectural principle that conceals complex, low-level implementation details behind simplified interfaces, restricting external entities to interacting only with an object's external behavior rather than its inner mechanisms, a constraint often realized through **encapsulation** (Core Concept 2.3), **inheritance** (Core Concept 2.4), and **polymorphism** (Core Concept 2.5).

Explicit abstraction—facilitated by Python's `abc` library—enforces a mandatory structural baseline for all derived subclasses. Furthermore, it prohibits direct instantiation of the abstract base class, ensuring access is only mediated through its child class implementations.

```

1  >>> from abc import ABC, abstractmethod
2  >>> class PrinterBlueprint(ABC):
3  ...     @abstractmethod
4  ...     def print_page(self, text):
5  ...         pass
6  ...
7  >>> class OfficePrinter(PrinterBlueprint): # Matches the blueprint EXACTLY
8  ...     def print_page(self, text):
9  ...         return f"Printing office document: {text}"
10 ...
11 >>> class BrokenPrinter(PrinterBlueprint): # Flaw: accidental rename
12 ...     def output_text(self, text):
13 ...         return f"Printing: {text}"
14 ...
15 >>> printer_1 = OfficePrinter() # success
16 >>> printer_2 = BrokenPrinter() # renamed mandatory method
17 Traceback (most recent call last):
18   File "<stdin>", line 1, in <module>
19 TypeError: Can't instantiate abstract class BrokenPrinter with abstract method print_page
20 >>> printer_3 = PrinterBlueprint() # can't call the abstract parent class
21 Traceback (most recent call last):
22   File "<stdin>", line 1, in <module>
23 TypeError: Can't instantiate abstract class PrinterBlueprint with abstract method
  < print_page

```

Code 28: Explicit abstraction using the `abc` module

As demonstrated above, the instantiation of the `BrokenPrinter` class fails because it neglects to implement the required `print_page()` method prescribed by its abstract base class, `PrinterBlueprint`. Conversely, the `OfficePrinter` instantiation succeeds because it strictly adheres to the same method signature outlined within `PrinterBlueprint`.

3 Error Handling & Debugging

3.1 Exceptions Handling

Core Concept 3.1: Exceptions

Exceptions are runtime errors that cause the abnormal termination of a program and its resources. Examples include `ZeroDivisionError`, which occurs when attempting to divide a value by zero, and `IndexError`, which arises when accessing an element within a collection (such as a list or array) using an invalid index.

Core Concept 3.2: Custom Exceptions

Developers can define **custom exceptions** by subclassing the base `Exception` class, which can subsequently be triggered using the `raise` statement.

```
1 >>> class InvalidAgeError(Exception):
2 ...     pass # no need for constructor
3 ...
4 >>> def verify_age(age):
5 ...     if age < 0:
6 ...         raise InvalidAgeError(f"Age cannot be negative. Received: {age}")
7 ...     print(f"Age {age} successfully verified.")
8 ...
9 >>> try:
10 ...     print("System: Verifying user age...")
11 ...     verify_age(-5)
12 ...
13 ... except InvalidAgeError as e:
14 ...     print(f"Error Type: {type(e).__name__}")
15 ...     print(f"Error Message: {e}")
16 ...
17 System: Verifying user age...
18 Error Type: InvalidAgeError
19 Error Message: Age cannot be negative. Received: -5
```

Code 29: Custom `InvalidAgeError` exception

As demonstrated above, the custom exception subclass does not require an explicit constructor. It inherits the constructor from the base `Exception` class, which is already designed to accept arguments—specifically, a string representing an error message.

Core Concept 3.3: try, except, & finally

The `try`, `except`, and `finally` structure provides a mechanism to manage and handle exceptions that arise during the execution of a designated block of code.

```
1 >>> try:
2 ...     print("Attempting the calculation...")
3 ...     result = 10 / 0
4 ...
5 ...     print(f"The result is {result}") # This line will be skipped because the error
6 ...     happens above
7 ... except ZeroDivisionError:
```

```

8 ...     print("Error: You cannot divide a number by zero!")
9 ... finally:
10 ...     print("Cleanup: The division operation has finished.")
11 ...
12 Attempting the calculation...
13 Error: You cannot divide a number by zero!
14 Cleanup: The division operation has finished.

```

Code 30: Exception handling with `try` / `except` / `finally` block

As demonstrated above, the code within the `try` block executes first. If a specified exception—in this case, a `ZeroDivisionError`—is raised, the runtime environment prevents premature termination and transfers control to the `except` block. The `finally` block subsequently executes regardless of whether the `try` block succeeded or failed. Consequently, the `finally` block is typically reserved for essential cleanup operations, such as terminating database connections or closing files.

If a specific exception type is not explicitly defined, a generic `except` block will default to catching all potential exceptions. This approach is generally considered **poor practice**, as it can obscure unrelated bugs and lead to unpredictable program behavior, particularly in complex software.

```

1 >>> try:
2 ...     print("Attempting the calculation...")
3 ...     result = 10 / 0
4 ...
5 ...     print(f"The result is {result}") # This line will be skipped because the error
    < happens above
6 ...
7 ... except: # catches ALL errors
8 ...     print("Error: You cannot divide a number by zero!")
9 ... finally:
10 ...     print("Cleanup: The division operation has finished.")
11 ...
12 Attempting the calculation...
13 Error: You cannot divide a number by zero!
14 Cleanup: The division operation has finished.

```

Code 31: Catching all exceptions with generic `except:` header; *poor practice*

A more robust practice involves implementing multiple `except` headers to handle distinct exception types individually. Utilizing the base `Exception` class as a fallback, paired with `as e` to capture the error object, allows the program to safely identify and log unexpected exceptions while maintaining application stability.

```

1 >>> try:
2 ...     user_input = "Hello"
3 ...     number = int(user_input)
4 ...
5 ... except ValueError as e:
6 ...     print(f"The message is: {e}")
7 ...     print(f"The error name is: {type(e).__name__}")
8 ... except Exception as e: # This is a fallback that catches anything else and prints its
    < name
9 ...     print(f"An unexpected {type(e).__name__} occurred: {e}")
10 ...
11 The message is: invalid literal for int() with base 10: 'Hello'
12 The error name is: ValueError

```

Code 32: Multiple `except` blocks

3.2 Logging

Core Concept 3.4: Logging

Logging is a systematic mechanism for tracking events, errors, and state changes that occur during software execution. While standard `print()` statements are frequently utilized for *preliminary* debugging, the built-in `logging` library provides a more robust framework suitable for larger applications. It allows developers to **categorize outputted messages by severity**.

The logging framework categorizes events into five primary severity levels, listed in increasing order of critical importance: `DEBUG`, `INFO`, `WARNING`, `ERROR`, and `CRITICAL`. By establishing a minimum severity threshold, the runtime environment can automatically filter out lower-level messages, ensuring that only pertinent information is captured and recorded.

```
1 >>> import sys
2 >>> import logging
3
4 >>> logging.basicConfig(level=logging.WARNING, format='%(levelname)s: %(message)s',
    < stream=sys.stdout, force=True) # force=True and stream=sys.stdout is needed to output
    < the logs within this pyconsole environment
5
6 >>> def divide_values(a, b):
7 ...     # This will be suppressed because DEBUG is lower than WARNING
8 ...     logging.debug(f"Attempting to divide {a} by {b}.")
9 ...     if b == 0:
10 ...         # This will be captured because ERROR is higher than WARNING
11 ...         logging.error("Division by zero attempted.")
12 ...         return None
13 ...     result = a / b
14 ...     # This will be suppressed because INFO is lower than WARNING
15 ...     logging.info(f"Division successful. Result is {result}.")
16 ...     return result
17 ...
18 >>> logging.warning("System is operating with minimal resources.")
19 WARNING: System is operating with minimal resources.
20 >>> divide_values(10, 0)
21 ERROR: Division by zero attempted.
```

Code 33: `logging` module usage at `WARNING` level

To retain log records for historical reference, a destination file can be specified using the `filename` parameter within the `logging.basicConfig()` function, which will route all subsequent log entries to that designated file.

3.3 Assertion

Core Concept 3.5: Assertions

An **assertion** is a programmatic debugging aid that functions as an internal sanity check. It allows developers to explicitly declare a condition that must evaluate to true at a specific point during execution. If the condition holds true, the program proceeds normally without interruption. However, if the condition evaluates to false, the runtime environment immediately halts execution and raises an `AssertionError`.

In Python, assertions are implemented utilizing the `assert` keyword, which evaluates a boolean expression and can optionally include a diagnostic error message.

```
1 >>> def apply_discount(original_price, discount_rate):
2 ...     # Assert that the parameters fall within logically valid bounds
3 ...     assert original_price > 0, "The original price must be strictly positive."
4 ...     assert 0 <= discount_rate <= 1, "The discount rate must be between 0 and 1."
5 ...     return original_price * (1 - discount_rate)
6 ...
7 >>> final_price = apply_discount(100.0, 0.2) # This will execute successfully
8 >>> print(f"Discounted price: {final_price}")
9 Discounted price: 80.0
10
11 >>> apply_discount(-50.0, 0.2) # This will immediately trigger an AssertionError
12 Traceback (most recent call last):
13   File "<stdin>", line 1, in <module>
14   File "<stdin>", line 3, in apply_discount
15 AssertionError: The original price must be strictly positive.
```

Code 34: Internal logic verification through `assert` keyword

In practice, assertions are designed to **verify internal logic** and identify states that the developer considers computationally impossible, primarily used as tools for development and testing phases.

4 File Input/Output and Data Handling

Core Concept 4.1: Files

A **file** is a continuous, one-dimensional **stream** of data—either plain text characters or raw binary bytes—that an application can sequentially read from or write to during execution.

Core Concept 4.2: File Input/Output

To interact with a file, a program must request a **file object** from the operating system. This object acts as a temporary communication bridge between the application's volatile memory and the persistent storage drive. The fundamental lifecycle of programmatic File I/O strictly adheres to three sequential phases.

(a) **Open:** Establishing the stream connection and declaring the intended access mode.

- `'r'` / **read:** Opens a file exclusively for reading, positioning the stream at the beginning of the document. If the specified file does not exist, the runtime raises a `FileNotFoundError`.
- `'w'` / **write:** If the file already exists, its **existing contents are immediately truncated** (*completely overwritten*) before new data is introduced. If it does not exist, a new file is generated.
- `'a'` / **append:** Opens a file for writing but **preserves existing data** by positioning the stream at the very end of the document. Any newly transmitted data is appended to the conclusion of the file. If the file does not exist, a new one is created.
- `'x'` / **exclusive creation:** Opens a file strictly for writing, functioning as a safeguard against data loss. **The file must not exist prior to execution;** if it does, a `FileExistsError` is raised, intentionally aborting the operation.

If working with binary files, simply append `'b'` to the end: `'rb'`, `'wb'`, `'ab'`, `'xb'`

(b) **Process:** Transmitting data through the stream via read or write operations.

(c) **Close:** Severing the connection to flush internal memory.

Modern Python development heavily relies on the `with` statement, which acts as a context manager. This structure guarantees that the file stream is **automatically and safely closed once the nested block of code finishes execution**, even if an unexpected exception is raised during the processing phase.

```
1 >>> with open("sensor_data.txt", "w") as file_stream:
2 ...     _ = file_stream.write("timestamp: 001, status: active\n")
3 ...     _ = file_stream.write("timestamp: 002, status: active\n")
4 ...     # file stream is automatically closed upon exiting this block
5 ...
6 >>> with open("sensor_data.txt", "r") as file_stream:
7 ...     content = file_stream.read()
8 ...     print(content)
9 ...
10 timestamp: 001, status: active
11 timestamp: 002, status: active
```

Code 35: File opening and closing through `with` statement

Core Concept 4.3: Serialization and Pickling

In data handling, **serialization** is the process of converting an in-memory object into a byte stream suitable for storage or transfer. In Python, this is implemented via the `pickle` module. The inverse operation—reconstructing a Python object from a byte stream—is known as **deserialization** (or *unpickling*).

Pickling is highly advantageous when working with complex, custom data structures that cannot be easily represented in standard, human-readable text formats like JSON or CSV.

The `pickle` API primarily relies on two functions for file interactions:

- `pickle.dump(obj, file)` serializes the target object and writes the resulting bytes directly to an open binary file stream.
- `pickle.load(file)` reads a binary file stream containing a serialized byte string and reconstructs the original Python object.

```
1 >>> import pickle
2
3 >>> session_data = { # complex data structure
4 ...     "user_id": 1042,
5 ...     "permissions": ["admin", "developer"],
6 ...     "matrix_weights": (0.85, 0.12, 0.94)
7 ... }
8
9 >>> with open("session.pkl", "wb") as binary_stream: # serializing data
10 ...     pickle.dump(session_data, binary_stream)
11 ...
12 >>> with open("session.pkl", "rb") as binary_stream: # deserializing data
13 ...     retrieved_data = pickle.load(binary_stream)
14 ...
15 >>> print(f"Data Type: {type(retrieved_data)}")
16 Data Type: <class 'dict'>
17 >>> print(f"Content: {retrieved_data}")
18 Content: {'user_id': 1042, 'permissions': ['admin', 'developer'], 'matrix_weights': (0.85,
19     0.12, 0.94)}
```

Code 36: Pickle object serialization through `pickle` module commands `.dump()` and `.load()`

It is important to keep in mind that deserializing a corrupted or maliciously constructed byte stream can trigger arbitrary code execution within the runtime environment. Consequently, objects should never be unpickled from untrusted or unauthenticated external sources.

5 Regular Expression

Core Concept 5.1: Regular Expression

Regular expressions (regex) are character sequences or structural patterns that, when evaluated by the `re` module, enable developers to perform substring searches and pattern validation against a given string.

Core Concept 5.2: Sequence Characters

A regular expression pattern may be composed of raw literal characters, such as `a` or `b`, or **sequence characters**, which are predefined escape sequences that each represent a distinct subset of the full Unicode character space.

- `\d` / **Digits**: Matches any numeric digit character from 0 to 9.
- `\D` / **Non Digits**: Matches any character that is not a numeric digit.
- `\s` / **White Space**: Matches whitespace characters such as spaces, tabs, and newline characters.
- `\S` / **Non White Space**: Matches any character that is not a whitespace character.
- `\w` / **Alphanumeric**: Matches alphanumeric characters and underscores.
- `\W` / **Non Alphanumeric**: Matches any character that is not alphanumeric or an underscore.
- `\b` / **Word Boundary**: Matches positions surrounding complete words.
- `\A` / **Start of String**: Restricts the search to the beginning of the string.
- `\Z` / **End of String**: Restricts the search to the end of the string.

Core Concept 5.3: Core Regular Expression Functions

The `re` module exposes several core functions that make up the primary toolset for applying regular expressions against a string. Each function differs in its scope of search and the form of its return value, as demonstrated in the following list.

- (a) The `re.search()` function scans the entire string and returns a **match object** corresponding to the first occurrence of the pattern, or `None` if no match is found; the exact matched substring is then retrievable via the `.group()` method on that object.

```
1 >>> import re
2 >>> string = "Take 1 up One 23 idea. One idea 45 at a time"
3
4 >>> result = re.search(r'\d\w+', string)
5 >>> print(result.group())
6 On
```

Code 37: `re.search()` paired with `.group()` returning the first matching substring

- (b) The `re.findall()` function traverses the full string and returns a list of all non-overlapping matches, making it the appropriate choice when multiple occurrences are expected. This does not need to be paired with the `.group` method.

```
1 >>> import re
2 >>> string = "Take 1 up One 23 idea. One idea 45 at a time"
3
4 >>> result = re.findall(r'O\w\w',string)
5 >>> print(result)
6 ['One', 'One']
```

Code 38: `re.findall()` returning a list of matching substrings

- (c) The `re.match()` function—paired with the `.group()` method—is more restrictive, as it anchors its search **exclusively to the beginning of the string** and returns `None` for any pattern not satisfied at that position.

```
1 >>> import re
2 >>> string = "Take 1 up One 23 idea. One idea 45 at a time"
3
4 >>> result = re.match('T\w\w',string)
5 >>> print(result.group())
6 Tak
```

Code 39: `re.match()` paired with `.group()` returning the matching substring at the beginning of reference string

- (d) The `re.sub()` performs an in-place substitution of all matched substrings with a specified replacement

```
1 >>> import re
2 >>> string = "Take 1 up One 23 idea. One idea 45 at a time"
3
4 >>> result = re.sub(r'One', 'Two', string)
5 >>> print(result)
6 Take 1 up Two 23 idea. Two idea 45 at a time
```

Code 40: `re.sub()` replacing all matched substrings

- (e) The `re.split()` partitions the string into a list of substrings at each position where the pattern is matched.

```
1 >>> import re
2 >>> string = "Take 1 up One 23 idea. One idea 45 at a time"
3
4 >>> result = re.split(r'\d+',string)
5 >>> print(result)
6 ['Take ', ' up One ', ' idea. One idea ', ' at a time']
```

Code 41: `re.split()` splitting given string at all match substring positions

Core Concept 5.4: Quantifiers

Quantifiers extend the expressive power of a regex pattern by specifying the number of times a preceding character or sequence character must occur in order for a match to be satisfied. They may enforce an exact

repetition count or define a permissible range.

- (a) The `{m}` quantifier constrains the preceding token to exactly m repetitions, whereas `{m,n}` defines an inclusive range between a minimum of m and a maximum of n repetitions.

```
1 >>> import re
2 >>> string = "Take 1 up One 23 idea.One idea 45 at a Time"
3
4 >>> result = re.findall(r'O\w{1}',string) #{m} exactly m repetition
5 >>> print(result)
6 ['On', 'On']
7
8 >>> result = re.findall(r'O\w{1,2}',string) #{m,n} m minimum, n maximum repetitions
9 >>> print(result)
10 ['One', 'One']
```

Code 42: Regexes using quantifiers

- (b) The `+` quantifier requires one or more occurrences, `*` permits zero or more, and `?` allows either zero or one, effectively rendering the preceding token optional.

```
1 >>> import re
2 >>> string = "Take 1 up One 23 idea.One idea 45 at a Time"
3
4 >>> result = re.findall(r'O\w+',string) #+ one or more repetitions
5 >>> print(result)
6 ['One', 'One']
7
8 >>> result = re.findall(r'O\w*',string) ## zero or more repetitions
9 >>> print(result)
10 ['One', 'One']
11
12 >>> result = re.findall(r'O\w?',string) ## zero or one repetitions
13 >>> print(result)
14 ['On', 'On']
```

Code 43: Regexes using quantifiers

Mind that quantifiers are greedy by default, meaning the engine will consume as many characters as possible while still producing an overall match. For instance, the `1,2` quantifier in Code 42 yields a list of `'One'` strings rather than `'On'`, as the engine greedily consumes the maximum number of permitted repetitions.

Core Concept 5.5: Special Characters

In addition to **sequence characters** (Core Concept 5.2) and **quantifiers** (Core Concept 5.2), the `re` module supports a set of **special characters** that modify the structural behaviour of a pattern, such as constraining its position within the string, escaping reserved metacharacters, or expressing logical alternation between sub-patterns.

- (a) The unescaped dot `.` serves as a wildcard, matching any single character except a newline; when a literal dot is intended, it must be escaped as `\.` to suppress its metacharacter interpretation. This escaping convention applies universally to all reserved metacharacters within the `re` module.

```
1 >>> import re
2 >>> string = "I live .. like cats oh yeah"
3
4 >>> result = re.search(r'l..e',string)
```



```

5 >>> print(result.group())
6 live
7
8 >>> result = re.search(r'\.\.',string)
9
10 >>> print(result.group())
11 ..

```

Code 44: `.` and `\.` special characters

- (b) The anchors `^` and `$` constrain a match to the start and end of the string respectively, analogously to `\A` and `\Z`.

```

1 >>> import re
2 >>> string = "I live .. like cats oh yeah"
3
4 >>> result = re.search(r'^I...',string) # beginning
5 >>> print(result.group())
6 I li
7
8 >>> result = re.search(r'...h$',string) # end
9 >>> print(result.group())
10 yeah

```

Code 45: Regex matching at the beginning and end of given string using `^` and `$`

- (c) Character classes, denoted by `[...]`, define an explicit set of permissible characters at a given position, while the negated form `[^...]` inverts this constraint to match any character outside the specified set.

```

1 >>> import re
2 >>> string = "I live .. like cats oh yeah"
3
4 >>> result = re.search(r'[aeiou]',string)
5 >>> print(result.group())
6 i
7
8 >>> result = re.search(r'[^I li]',string)
9 >>> print(result.group())
10 v

```

Code 46: Defining sets of permissible characters in a regex

- (d) The alternation operator `(R|S)` evaluates two or more sub-expressions and returns a match if either is satisfied, providing a concise mechanism for expressing logical disjunction within a pattern.

```

1 >>> import re
2 >>> string = "I live .. like cats oh yeah"
3
4 >>> result = re.search(r'(cats|dogs)',string) #(R|S) specifies multiple regular
  < expressions to match; either R OR S
5 >>> print(result.group())
6 cats

```

Code 47: Alternation operator `(R|S)` in regex matching

6 Threading

Core Concept 6.1: Threading & Global Interpreter Lock (GIL)

So far, all previous coding examples shown have been **single-threaded**, meaning that line 1 finishes before moving onto line 2, line 3, and so on. However, with the `threading` module, a developer is able to execute several concurrent operations within a single **multi-threaded** process in a practice called **threading**.

Core Concept 6.2: Main Thread

The main thread that is always running is called the `MainThread`, which can be retrieved through the `threading` module.

```
1 >>> import threading
2
3 >>> print('Current thread that is running: {}'.format(threading.current_thread().name))
4 Current thread that is running: MainThread
5
6 >>> if threading.current_thread() == threading.main_thread():
7 ...     print('Main Thread')
8 ...
9 Main Thread
```

Code 48: `MainThread` confirmation

6.1 Threading Methods

Core Concept 6.3: Threading Through Functions

Threading in its most elementary form is invoked by passing a callable into the `Thread` object, which instantiates a new thread of execution. The `Thread` constructor accepts two principal parameters: `target`, which holds a reference to the function object in its non-invoked state, and `args`, which supplies the positional arguments to that function as a **tuple**.

```
1 >>> import threading
2
3 >>> def displayNumbers(count):
4 ...     i = 0
5 ...     print(threading.current_thread().name)
6 ...     while i <= count:
7 ...         print(i)
8 ...         i += 1
9 ...
10 >>> print(threading.current_thread().name)
11 MainThread
12
13 >>> # notice the args value below is a tuple
14 >>> t = threading.Thread(target=displayNumbers, args = (5,), name =
...     'displayNumbersThread')
15 >>> t.start()
16 displayNumbersThread
17 0
18 1
```

```
19 2
20 3
21 4
22 5
23 >>> t.join()
24 >>> print("displayNumbers function finished")
25 displayNumbers function finished
```

Code 49: Simple threading via a function

As demonstrated above, the thread object `t` is dispatched via the `.start()` method, which schedules the thread for execution and returns immediately, allowing the main thread to continue concurrently. It is important to distinguish `.start()` from the lower-level `.run()` method: whereas `.start()` delegates execution to a newly spawned OS-level thread, `.run()` invokes the target callable directly on the *calling* thread, producing strictly **sequential rather than concurrent behaviour**.

The `.join()` method causes the main thread to halt until `t` has completed execution, thereby synchronising the two threads before control advances to subsequent statements. In this example, the main thread is suspended until `displayNumbers` returns, after which the final print statement is reached.

Finally, observe that invoking `threading.current_thread().name` from within `t`'s execution context yields `displayNumbersThread`, reflecting the identifier supplied via the `name` parameter at construction time. This illustrates that each `Thread` instance maintains its own execution context, including thread-local identity metadata accessible at runtime.

Core Concept 6.4: Threading Through Class Methods

Analogously to the function-based approach demonstrated in Core Concept 6.3, threads may equally be dispatched by targeting instance methods of a class.

```
1 >>> import threading
2 >>> from time import sleep # the sleep function simply makes the program wait
3
4 >>> class MyThread:
5 ...     def displayNumbers(self):
6 ...         i = 0
7 ...         print(threading.current_thread().name)
8 ...         while i <= 3:
9 ...             print(i)
10 ...            i+=1
11 ...
12 >>> obj = MyThread()
13
14 >>> t1 = threading.Thread(target=obj.displayNumbers,name='displayNumbers1')
15 >>> t1.start()
16 displayNumbers1
17 0
18 1
19 2
20 3
21 >>> sleep(0.5)
22
23 >>> t2 = threading.Thread(target=obj.displayNumbers,name='displayNumbers2')
24 >>> t2.start()
25 displayNumbers2
26 0
27 1
```

```

28 2
29 3
30 >>> t1.join()
31 >>> t2.join()

```

Code 50: Multi-threading via a class method

The `sleep(0.5)` calls serve to introduce a deliberate delay between the dispatch of `t1` and `t2`, imposing an approximate execution ordering. In their absence, the relative scheduling of the two threads is delegated entirely to the Python thread scheduler, which provides no ordering guarantees—the threads may interweave arbitrarily or execute in an effectively simultaneous fashion depending on the underlying system load.

Core Concept 6.5: Common Producer/Consumer Pattern

The producer-consumer pattern is one of the most canonical demonstrations of multi-threaded coordination, wherein two threads operate concurrently on a shared resource.

```

1  >>> import threading
2  >>> import time
3
4  >>> class Producer:
5  ...     def __init__(self):
6  ...         self.products = []
7  ...         self.ordersplaced = False
8  ...     def produce(self):
9  ...         for i in range(1,5):
10 ...             self.products.append('Product'+str(i))
11 ...             time.sleep(1)
12 ...             print('Item Added')
13 ...             self.ordersplaced = True
14 ...
15 >>> class Consumer:
16 ...     def __init__(self,prod):
17 ...         self.prod = prod
18 ...     def consume(self):
19 ...         while self.prod.ordersplaced == False:
20 ...             print("Waiting for the orders")
21 ...             time.sleep(0.4)
22 ...             print('Orders Shipped {}'.format(self.prod.products))
23 ...
24 >>> p = Producer()
25 >>> c = Consumer(p)
26
27 >>> t1 = threading.Thread(target = p.produce)
28 >>> t2 = threading.Thread(target = c.consume)
29
30 >>> t1.start()
31 >>> t2.start()
32 Waiting for the orders
33 >>> t1.join()
34 Waiting for the orders
35 Waiting for the orders
36 Item Added
37 Waiting for the orders
38 Waiting for the orders
39 Item Added
40 Waiting for the orders
41 Waiting for the orders
42 Waiting for the orders
43 Item Added

```

```

44 Waiting for the orders
45 Waiting for the orders
46 Item Added
47 >>> t2.join()
48 Orders Shipped ['Product1', 'Product2', 'Product3', 'Product4']

```

Code 51: Multi-threading consumer & producer pattern

As illustrated in Code 51, the consumer thread `t2` continuously polls the shared `ordersplaced` flag within a busy-wait loop, deferring execution of the shipment statement until the flag evaluates to `True`. This state transition is driven by the producer thread `t1`, which iteratively populates the product list via its `for` loop before setting `ordersplaced = True` upon completion.

6.2 Locks

Core Concept 6.6: Locks

When multiple threads access a shared resource concurrently, conditions may arise in which overlapping operations produce inconsistent or corrupted state. To prevent this, Python's `threading` module provides the `Lock()` class, which enforces **mutual exclusion** by ensuring that at most one thread may execute a designated critical section at any given time.

```

1 >>> import threading
2
3 >>> class BookMyBus:
4 ...     def __init__(self, availableSeats):
5 ...         self.availableSeats = availableSeats
6 ...         self.l = threading.Lock()
7 ...     def buy(self, seatsRequested):
8 ...         self.l.acquire() #starting the locked environment
9 ...         print('Total seats available: {}'.format(self.availableSeats))
10 ...         if(self.availableSeats >= seatsRequested):
11 ...             print('Confirming a seat')
12 ...             print('Processing the payment')
13 ...             print('Printing the Ticket')
14 ...             self.availableSeats -= seatsRequested
15 ...         else:
16 ...             print('Sorry. No seats available')
17 ...         self.l.release() #ending the locked environment
18 ...
19 >>> obj = BookMyBus(10)
20
21 >>> t1 = threading.Thread(target=obj.buy, args=(3,))
22 >>> t2 = threading.Thread(target=obj.buy, args=(4,))
23 >>> t3 = threading.Thread(target=obj.buy, args=(4,))
24
25 >>> t1.start()
26 Total seats available: 10
27 Confirming a seat
28 Processing the payment
29 Printing the Ticket
30 >>> t2.start()
31 Total seats available: 7
32 Confirming a seat
33 Processing the payment
34 Printing the Ticket
35 >>> t3.start()
36 Total seats available: 3

```

```

37 Sorry. No seats available
38 >>> t1.join()
39 >>> t2.join()
40 >>> t3.join()

```

Code 52: Threading locks enforcing mutual exclusion

The critical section—the entirety of the `buy` method—is surrounded by paired calls to `.acquire()` and `.release()`. When a thread invokes `.acquire()`, it attempts to take ownership of the lock: if the lock is currently unheld, the thread acquires it and proceeds into the critical section; if another thread already holds the lock, the calling thread blocks until the lock is relinquished. Once the protected operations are complete, `.release()` surrenders ownership of the lock, allowing the next waiting thread to acquire it and enter the critical section in turn.

Core Concept 6.7: Thread Synchronisation

Thread synchronisation (*communication*) is facilitated through the `Condition` class and its associated methods, `wait()` and `notify()`; these methods must be invoked within a locked context in order to prevent data corruption.

```

1 >>> import threading
2 >>> import time
3
4 >>> class Producer:
5 ...     def __init__(self):
6 ...         self.products = []
7 ...         self.c = threading.Condition() # the Condition class already has the lock
8 ...         method in-built into it, thus you don't need to invoke a separate lock method
9 ...     def produce(self):
10 ...         self.c.acquire() # locked environment setting through the Condition class
11 ...         for i in range(1,5):
12 ...             self.products.append('Product'+str(i))
13 ...             time.sleep(1)
14 ...             print('Item Added: Product' + str(i))
15 ...             self.c.notify() # where the program ends and notifies the consumer
16 ...             self.c.release()
17
18 >>> class Consumer:
19 ...     def __init__(self,prod):
20 ...         self.prod = prod
21 ...     def consume(self):
22 ...         self.prod.c.acquire()
23 ...         self.prod.c.wait()
24 ...         self.prod.c.release()
25 ...         print('Orders Shipped: {}'.format(self.prod.products))
26
27 ... p = Producer()
28 ... File "<stdin>", line 9
29 ...     p = Producer()
30 ... ^
31
32 SyntaxError: invalid syntax
33 >>> c = Consumer(p)
34
35 >>> t1 = threading.Thread(target = p.produce)
36 >>> t2 = threading.Thread(target = c.consume)
37
38 >>> t1.start()
39 >>> t2.start()
40
41 Orders Shipped ['Product1', 'Product2', 'Product3', 'Product4', 'Product1']

```

```

38
39 >>> t1.join()
40 Item Added
41 Item Added
42 Item Added
43 Item Added
44 >>> t2.join()

```

Code 53: Threading using the `Condition` class

Consider the scenario in which the Python runtime schedules the `t2` thread (*consumer thread*) first; upon entering `consume()`, it acquires the lock and immediately finds the product list empty, as the producer has not yet executed. This results in a deadlock: the lock remains held within the `consume()` block, preventing the `produce()` function from acquiring it, since both threads contend over the same underlying `Condition` instance `self.c` and `self.prod.c`.

To prevent the above deadlock scenario, the `wait()` method—as seen in Code 53—performs three critical operations.

- (1) It **automatically releases the lock** held within the `acquire()` / `release()` block of the `consume()` function, returning it to the general pool so that the producer thread may acquire it.
- (2) It suspends the calling thread and places it into an internal waiting queue managed by the `Condition` object.
- (3) It remains suspended in the waiting queue until explicitly signalled by a call to `notify()`.

Once the lock is released back to the pool, the scheduler grants it to the `t1` thread (*producer thread*), which enters `produce()`, populates the product list, and completes its work. Prior to calling `release()`, the producer invokes `notify()`, which promotes the consumer thread `t2` from the waiting queue back to a runnable state, subsequently allowing it to acquire the lock and correctly print the shipped orders.

In summary, the `wait()`–`notify()` mechanism is a tool designed explicitly to handle unpredictable scheduling order arising from **race conditions** (*the Free-For-All race*), and to enforce a correct, deterministic execution sequence across cooperating threads.

6.3 Queuing

Core Concept 6.8: Queuing

The `queue` module provides a thread-safe mechanism for passing objects between threads, offering a simpler and more robust alternative implementation of the producer-consumer pattern with locks (*Core Concept 6.6*).

```

1 >>> import random
2 >>> import time
3 >>> import queue
4 >>> import threading
5
6 >>> def producer(q):
7 ...     for _ in range(2):
8 ...         print('Producing')
9 ...         q.put(random.randint(1,50)) #putting the random integer into a queue
10 ...        print('Produced')
11 ...        time.sleep(0.5)
12 ...

```

```

13 >>> def consumer(q):
14 ...     for _ in range(2):
15 ...         print('Ready to consume')
16 ...         print('Consume Data: {}'.format(q.get())) #returning the queued integer
17 ...         time.sleep(0.5)
18 ...
19 >>> q = queue.Queue()
20 >>> t1 = threading.Thread(target=consumer, args=(q,))
21 >>> t2 = threading.Thread(target=producer, args=(q,))
22
23 >>> t1.start()
24 Ready to consume
25 >>> t2.start()
26 Producing
27 Produced
28 >>> t1.join()
29 Consume Data: 25
30 Ready to consume
31 Producing
32 Produced
33 Consume Data: 46
34 >>> t2.join()

```

Code 54: Queueing using `Queue()`

As illustrated in Code 54, the `Queue()` class internally manages all requisite locking, ensuring that concurrent `put()` and `get()` operations across multiple threads remain free from race conditions and data corruption. Specifically, the `put()` method enqueues the random integer generated by `producer()` into the shared `q` object, while the `get()` method dequeues and returns the first item in FIFO order for consumption by `consumer()`, which outputs the retrieved value via a `print` statement.

Core Concept 6.9: Alternative Queue Ordering

Beyond the default FIFO ordering, the `queue` module exposes alternative queue classes that govern the order in which elements are dequeued, providing developers with flexible retrieval strategies suited to different scheduling requirements.

```

1 >>> import queue
2
3 >>> lq = queue.LifoQueue() # last in first out
4 >>> lq.put(400)
5 >>> lq.put(100)
6 >>> lq.put(500)
7 >>> lq.put(50)
8 >>> while not lq.empty(): # this is another function to specify an empty queue
9 ...     print(lq.get(), end=' ')
10 ... print()
11 File "<stdin>", line 3
12     print()
13     ~~~~~
14 SyntaxError: invalid syntax
15
16 >>> pq = queue.PriorityQueue() #in order
17 >>> pq.put(400)
18 >>> pq.put(100)
19 >>> pq.put(500)
20 >>> pq.put(50)

```



```

21 >>> while not pq.empty():
22 ...     print(pq.get(), end=' ')
23 ...     print()
24 File "<stdin>", line 3
25     print()
26     ~~~~~
27 SyntaxError: invalid syntax
28
29 >>> pq = queue.PriorityQueue()
30 >>> pq.put((400, 'John')) # if the item in the queue is a str, then make a tuple with a int
    ~~~~~ in the first index and it will use that number to define the order
31 >>> pq.put((100, 'Bob'))
32 >>> pq.put((500, 'Ahmed'))
33 >>> pq.put((50, 'Bharath'))
34 >>> while not pq.empty():
35 ...     print(pq.get()[1], end=' ') #insert the index to choose only the name in the
    ~~~~~ prioritized order
36 ...
37 Bharath Bob John Ahmed

```

Code 55: Custom queue ordering

As demonstrated in Code 55, the `LifoQueue` class implements a last-in, first-out retrieval policy, whereby the most recently enqueued element is always dequeued first. The `PriorityQueue` class, by contrast, dequeues elements in ascending order of their priority value; when the enqueued items are non-numeric, a tuple of the form `(priority, item)` may be supplied, whereupon the queue uses the integer at index zero to determine the retrieval order, with only the associated item at index one being extracted for use.

6.4 Daemon Threads

Core Concept 6.10: Daemon Threads

A **daemon thread** is a thread that runs silently in the background and is automatically terminated by the Python runtime as soon as all non-daemon threads have completed execution. Unlike standard threads, daemon threads are not awaited by the interpreter upon program exit, meaning any work they have not yet completed is abandoned without notice when the main thread finishes.

```

1 >>> import threading
2 >>> import time
3
4 >>> def background_task():
5 ...     while True:
6 ...         print('Daemon running...')
7 ...         time.sleep(0.5)
8 ...
9 >>> def main_task():
10 ...     for i in range(3):
11 ...         print('Main thread working: step {}'.format(i))
12 ...         time.sleep(1)
13 ...
14 >>> t1 = threading.Thread(target=background_task)
15 >>> t1.daemon = True # designates t1 as a daemon thread
16 >>> t2 = threading.Thread(target=main_task)
17
18 >>> t1.start()
19 Daemon running...
20 >>> t2.start()
21 Main thread working: step 0

```

```
22 >>> t2.join() # only the non-daemon thread is joined; once t2 finishes, t1 is killed
    ↪ automatically
23 Daemon running...
24 Main thread working: step 1
25 Daemon running...
26 Daemon running...
27 Main thread working: step 2
28 Daemon running...
29 Daemon running...
```

Code 56: Daemon thread termination behaviour

As illustrated in Code 56, the daemon flag is set via the `.daemon` attribute prior to invoking `start()`; assigning it thereafter raises a `RuntimeError`. Once the non-daemon thread `t2` completes its iteration and `join()` returns, the Python runtime terminates the process entirely, forcibly halting the daemon thread `t1` regardless of its current state within the `while` loop.

It is worth noting that daemon threads are deliberately not joined, as doing so would block the main thread indefinitely given their non-terminating nature. This distinguishes them from standard threads, where `join()` is used to ensure orderly completion.

7 Third-Party Libraries

7.1 Package Management

pip and PyPI conda

7.2 Third-Party Libraries

packages requests <https://requests.readthedocs.io/en/latest/> seaborn <https://seaborn.pydata.org/generated/seaborn.objects.Plot.html>
IPython.display <https://ipython.readthedocs.io/en/stable/api/generated/IPython.display.html> scikit-learn <https://scikit-learn.org/1.5/api/index.html> statsmodels <https://www.statsmodels.org/stable/api.html> scipy <https://docs.scipy.org/doc/scipy/reference/>

7.2.1 Data Science

numpy <https://numpy.org/doc/stable/reference/> pandas <https://pandas.pydata.org/docs/reference/index.html> matplotlib <https://matplotlib.org/stable/api/index.html>

7.2.2 placeholder

8 Other

del input() print sep end